

NIKITA MUKHORTOV

Product Design Lead / Staff Product Designer | AI, Developer Tools, Fintech

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product Design Lead and hands-on staff-level designer with 9+ years of experience taking AI products, developer tools, fintech, marketplaces, telecom, consumer, blockchain, and Web3 products from discovery and strategy through research, interaction design, coded prototyping, validation, delivery, launch, and post-launch review. Former software developer who leads cross-functional work and manages design teams across hiring, goals, performance reviews, development, compensation, and team composition while remaining hands-on. Selected product milestones include 29,370 public-preview installs and 500,000 active subscribers.

CORE SKILLS

Product: product management, product strategy, product discovery, roadmapping, KPI definition, product analytics, experimentation, A/B testing, go-to-market, product launch, post-launch review.

Design and research: AI product design, AI UX, generative AI, LLM UX, agentic workflows, human-AI interaction, developer tools, platform design, qualitative and quantitative user research, participatory design, usability testing, interaction design, AI design systems, visual identity, AI-assisted prototyping, Figma, Framer, Amplitude.

Leadership: cross-functional leadership, Product/Engineering/Research/Data collaboration, stakeholder management, people management, design team leadership, mentoring, design operations, B2B SaaS, fintech, marketplaces, consumer products, blockchain, Web3, creative direction, marketing design, motion design.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

JetBrains | Product Design Lead, AI & R&D

Sep 2025 - Present | Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Established a product design function in R&D and introduced coded prototyping with Research and Product Management to validate complete AI interactions before engineering investment.
- Built shared AI interaction patterns for context selection, inspectable plans, execution control, evidence review, correction, and recovery.
- Owned Agentic Markdown end to end: developer research, product framing, a coded five-stage prototype, moderated validation, and a public waitlist test.
- Co-authored Trust-Calibrated Code Review; translated 64 practitioner problems from 17 discovery participants into a validated three-level IDE workflow tested with 43 professionals. 72% would use the proposed tool, 63% expected lower overall review effort, and 52% expected lower trust-assessment effort.
- Also developed the research prototype's visual identity and an internal AI-assisted design system, speeding up prototype preparation and hypothesis validation.

JetBrains | Product Designer / Product Design Lead, Rider / .NET

Sep 2022 - Sep 2025 | Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Built Rider's product-design operating model and managed three product designers, owning hiring, goals, performance reviews, development, compensation, and team composition while remaining hands-on; embedded research, prototyping, handoff, design review, and release-quality review into delivery.
- Led product design across three shipped product initiatives: contextual AI, agent workflows, and Monitoring. Monitoring shipped in Rider 2024.1, 2024.2, and 2025.2.
- Designed and launched ReSharper AI Assistant in 2023.2 across four workflow groups and three native entry paths; the host product has 3.03M cumulative Marketplace installs and a 4.3/5 rating.
- Led the AI Assistant for VS Code product model and public-preview launch across eight languages; the extension reached 29,370 unique Marketplace installs by 24 Aug 2026.
- Also built visual identities and design systems from scratch for AI Assistant for VS Code and ReSharper AI.
- During the Rider product period, surveyed primary-IDE share increased from 35% to 44% as a team-level adoption outcome.

TON Foundation / The Open Platform | Lead Product Designer / Head of Product Design

May 2021 - Sep 2022 | Remote

- Rebuilt TON's public product around four audience activation paths and live network proof; 115 validators were active at relaunch. Also created the TON Foundation and TOP visual identities from scratch.
- Led TON Wallet's onboarding, portfolio, contact-based transfers, exchange, and Telegram integration, including its new visual identity and design system. During that quarter, registered wallets across TON grew from 382,148 to 901,015 (+136%).
- Built and led a multidisciplinary design team anchored by four product designers and spanning motion, graphic and illustration, and marketing design; owned hiring, goals, performance reviews, development, compensation, and team composition.
- Built a four-stage portfolio process and guided launch readiness for Getgems and STON.fi; later public scale reached \$7.6B volume, 36.4M swaps, and 5.8M users for STON.fi, and 4.5M+ connected wallets for Getgems.

Yandex / Auto.ru | Lead Product Designer

Oct 2020 - Jun 2021 | Moscow, Russia

- Designed linked buyer and seller journeys for Auto.ru Safe Deal after research showed that more than 60% of buyers and one in five sellers needed a safer transaction path; covered four buyer tasks and five seller tasks from agreement through fulfillment.
- Took the transaction service from research and service blueprint through prototype and cross-functional delivery. Auto.ru launched it with Tinkoff in Oct 2021; the published online process took up to 15 minutes.

Koshelek | Contract Product Designer

Jun 2020 - Oct 2020 | Remote

- Designed the end-to-end Android NFC payment state machine across card provisioning, terminal interaction, processing, success, and recovery.
- The rollout expanded issuer coverage from two Mastercard banks to six Visa banks (3x coverage) through a consistent five-state payment model; the platform served 7M+ users during the project period.

Simple | Product Designer

Jul 2019 - Jun 2020 | Remote

- Used research, Amplitude analysis, experimentation, and subscription UX to shape Simple's pivot from a fasting timer to a daily program across iOS, Android, Web, and watchOS. Also built its visual identity and design system from scratch.
- The product added 350,000 users in Dec 2019 and exceeded 1 million iOS and Android users by Feb 2020 as a team-level product outcome.

Sber | Product Designer

Jul 2018 - Jun 2019 | Moscow, Russia

- Designed five connected SberMobile journeys - selection, order, activation, payment, and support - across Sberbank Online, telecom, and employee service surfaces.
- During the product period, SberMobile grew from 10,000+ first-week connections to 500,000 active subscribers and expanded from 4 to 50 regions.

Alfa-Bank | Software Developer / Product Designer

Jul 2017 - Jun 2018 | Moscow, Russia

- Moved from software development into product design and redesigned five end-to-end B2B foreign-trade workflows through interviews, journey mapping, adaptive prototypes, usability testing, KPI definition, and delivery.
- Created one reusable service model across web, desktop, and mobile product surfaces for a business unit that reported 53,000 active medium-business clients, 46% annual client growth, and RUB 19B operating revenue in 2018.

SELECTED PUBLICATION

Trust-Calibrated Code Review. Participatory design study on reviewing multi-file changes from LLM agents. JetBrains x Lund University, 2026. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.01969>

EDUCATION

Saint Petersburg State University of Aerospace and Instrumentation
Bachelor of Technology, Information Technology | 2013 - 2017